TG ACADEMY / EXECUTIVE LEARNING

UNDERSTANDING YOUR PERSONAL RELATIONSHIP WITH TIME

WEEK 1

YOUR TIME IS SHAPED BY MORE THAN A CALENDAR

Understand beliefs, behaviours and pressures before attempting to change routines.

Time awareness begins with an honest account of how you relate to time, not with a new productivity app.

BELIEFS | BEHAVIOURS | BOUNDARIES

TIME IS EXPERIENCED THROUGH

- **Beliefs → "I must always be available"**
- **Choices → What receives attention**
- **Constraints → Work, care, resources**
- **Emotions → Stress, guilt, urgency**

THE PERSONAL TIME MINDSET

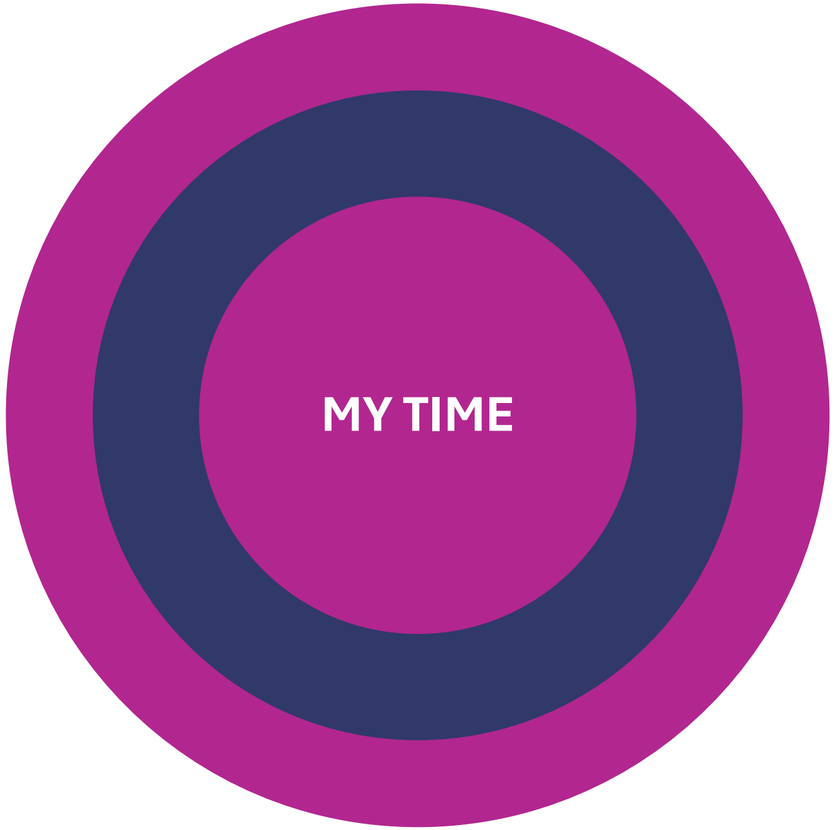
Four lenses reveal why the same 24 hours feel very different to different people.

CONTROL

How much discretion do I have?

VALUE

What deserves my attention?



EXPECTATION

Whose demands shape my day?

IDENTITY

What do I believe a “good day” looks like?

CASE LAB: TWO PEOPLE, TWO TIME STORIES

Same 24-hour day. Different responsibilities, assumptions and choices.

CASE A
AMINA, WORKING PARENT

Amina works full-time and provides evening care. She says “I have no time for myself.” Her fixed commitments are substantial; she also feels guilty declining optional requests.

CASE B
DANIEL, EARLY-CAREER PROFESSIONAL

Daniel has flexible evenings but spends them responding to non-urgent messages. He says “I’m always busy,” yet has not made progress on his qualification.

DISCUSS: What is a real constraint? What is a habit? What is one respectful, realistic adjustment for each person?

THE 168-HOUR WEEK: THE FULL PICTURE

Every week contains 168 hours; not all of them are discretionary.



- **Sleep 56h**
- **Work + commute 45h**
- **Care + household 30h**
- **Meals + personal care 17h**
- **Flexible time 20h**

Illustrative allocation only • Categories must not overlap • Real circumstances differ substantially

FROM TOTAL HOURS TO USABLE OPPORTUNITIES

The question is not “How much free time?” but “What is realistically available?”

168h	– 56h	– 45h	– 30h	– 17h	20h
TOTAL WEEK	SLEEP	WORK + TRAVEL	CARE + HOME	PERSONAL CARE	REMAINING

Reality check

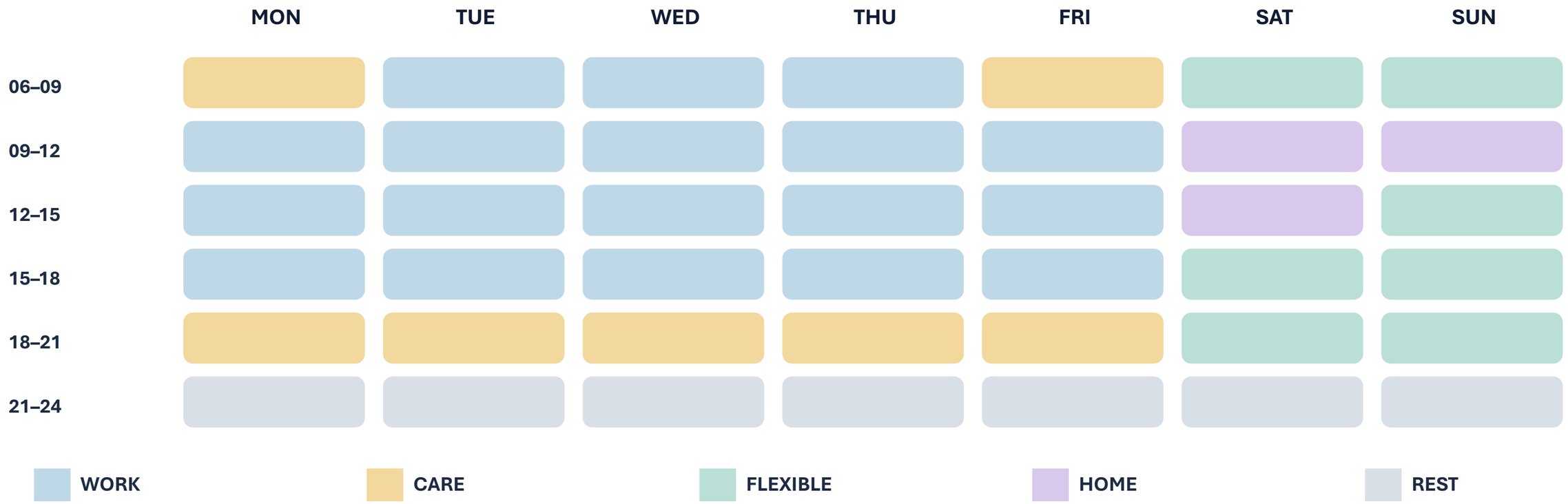
The remaining 20h may still contain unpredictable needs, relationships, recovery and essential administration.

Design principle

Plan meaningful priorities within real constraints; protect flexibility rather than allocating every minute.

ACTIVITY: BUILD A REALITY-BASED WEEKLY MAP

Map commitments first; locate realistic opportunities second.



DISTINGUISHING BETWEEN BEING BUSY, PRODUCTIVE AND EFFECTIVE

Busy ≠ productive ≠ effective

Three different questions reveal three different levels of contribution.

BUSY	**Am I active?**	Movement, effort, many tasks
PRODUCTIVE	**Am I producing?**	Useful outputs and completed tasks
EFFECTIVE	**Am I achieving what matters?**	Relevant outcomes and impact

The goal is not maximum activity; it is meaningful results within sustainable capacity.

THE OUTPUT–OUTCOME DISTINCTION

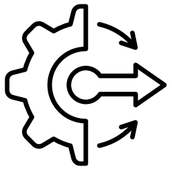
Activity counts are useful, but they do not tell the whole story.



ACTIVITY

What I did

- Sent 25 messages
- Read for two hours
- Held four meetings



OUTPUT

What I produced

- Shared an agreed plan
- Completed two chapters
- Published meeting decisions



OUTCOME

What changed

- Decision made on time
- Improved understanding
- A problem was resolved

DECISION CLINIC: WHAT WAS ACTUALLY ACHIEVED?

Use the same evidence to distinguish activity, output and outcome.

SCENARIO

A project manager attends six meetings, sends 40 emails and updates a tracker. The launch decision remains unresolved.

Is this busy, productive or effective?

01	**Activity**	Six meetings + 40 emails
02	**Output**	Tracker updated
03	**Outcome**	Launch decision still pending

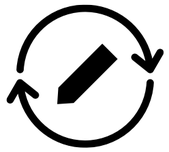
WHERE TIME LEAKS HIDE

Small recurring inefficiencies accumulate, often without being noticed.



INTERRUPTIONS

Unplanned conversations and alerts



REWORK

Correcting preventable errors



WAITING

Delays and unclear hand-offs



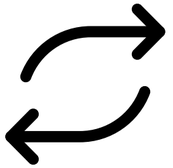
SEARCHING

Finding files, keys or information



OVER-MEETING

Low-value attendance and repetition



SWITCHING

Repeated context changes

THE COMPOUNDING COST OF SMALL DELAYS

A recurring 12-minute avoidable delay can become a meaningful weekly drain.

12	3	5	180
MINUTES per occurrence	**TIMES** each working day	**DAYS** per week	**MINUTES** per week

12 × 3 × 5 = 180 minutes = 3 hours each week

FIND THE CAUSE, NOT JUST THE SYMPTOM

A 5-Why conversation can expose a process issue behind repeated delays.



Facilitator Prompt

What evidence supports each “why”? What could the team change without adding pressure?



THE HABIT LOOP BEHIND DAILY TIME CHOICES

Repeated cues can trigger automatic actions, helpful or unhelpful.

1. CUE

A notification arrives

→

2. RESPONSE

I open the app immediately

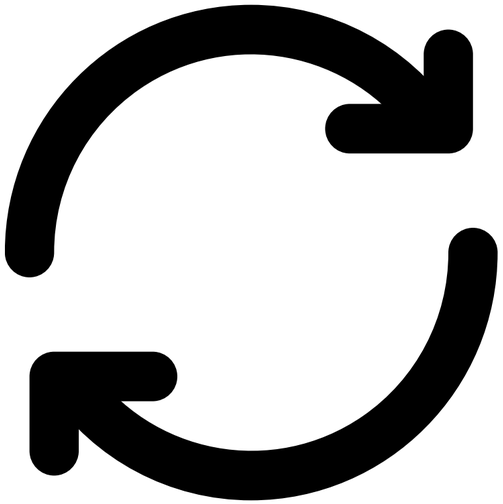
3. SHORT-TERM EFFECT

I feel updated or relieved

←

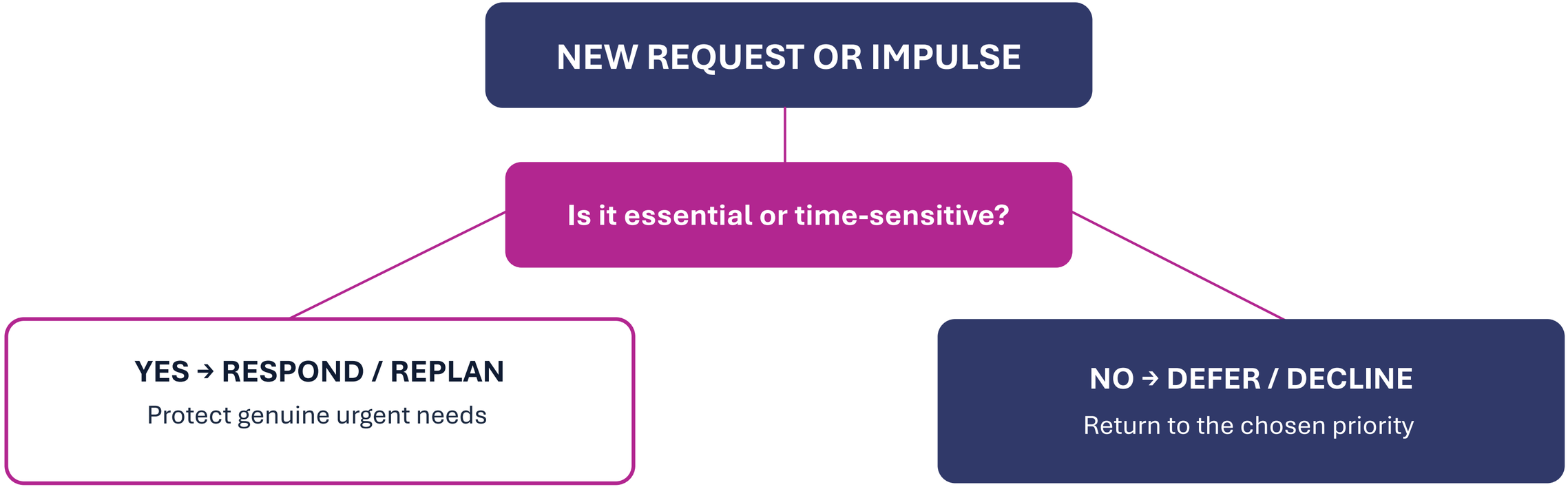
4. LONG-TERM PATTERN

Focus becomes fragmented



THE 30-SECOND DECISION FILTER

A small pause can prevent a low-value activity from consuming a high-value window.



HABIT REDESIGN: REPLACE, DON’T JUST REMOVE

Design one small behaviour change and test it for five days.

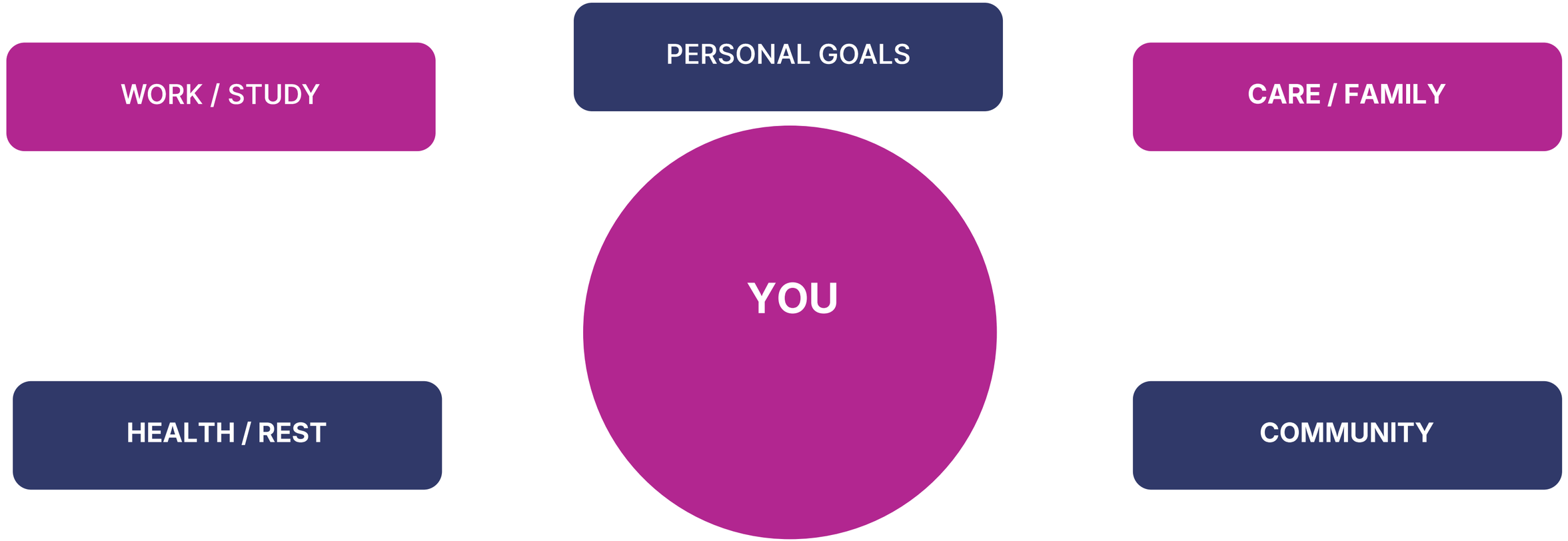
TRIGGER	OLD RESPONSE	NEW RESPONSE	EVIDENCE
After lunch	**Check social media**	**Review tomorrow’s top task**	**Did I do it?**
Existing cue	Automatic pattern	Useful replacement	Five-day check

5-DAY TRACKER

MON	TUE	WED	THU	FRI

ONE PERSON, MULTIPLE ROLES

A realistic schedule accounts for competing responsibilities, not just job tasks.



WHEN IMPORTANT ROLES COLLIDE

Use consequence, flexibility and support to make respectful trade-offs.

DEMAND	FIXED?	CONSEQUENCE	POSSIBLE RESPONSE
Client deadline	Mostly	Delay affects project	Negotiate scope / seek help
School collection	Yes	Care obligation	Protect time; plan travel
Optional event	No	Low consequence	Decline or reschedule
Sleep / recovery	Essential	Wellbeing impact	Protect adequate recovery

COMMUNICATE CAPACITY BEFORE IT BECOMES A CRISIS

Practical language for negotiating time, scope and support.

CLARIFY

“Which of these two deliverables has priority?”

Use when requests compete.

NEGOTIATE

“I can complete A by Friday; B would need Monday.”

Use when capacity is limited.

SHARE

“Can we split preparation and follow-up?”

Use when work can be distributed.

DECLINE

“I cannot take this on this week, but here is an alternative.”

Use for optional commitments.

THE SIX-DIMENSION BASELINE

24 statements • 4 per dimension • a developmental self-assessment, not a clinical test.

01 AWARENESS

4 items • 4–20 points

02 PRIORITIES

4 items • 4–20 points

03 CAPACITY

4 items • 4–20 points

04 FOCUS

4 items • 4–20 points

05 EXECUTION

4 items • 4–20 points

06 ARCHITECTURE

4 items • 4–20 points

SCORE CONSISTENTLY; INTERPRET CAUTIOUSLY

A clear scoring method matters more than assigning impressive-sounding labels.

1	2	3	4	5
Strongly disagree	Disagree	Neither / unsure	Agree	Strongly agree

DIMENSION SCORE

4 item responses added = 4–20

OVERALL SCORE

Six dimension totals = 24–120

Use the original Week 1 item wording and scoring directions, including any reverse-keyed items.

LEAVE WEEK 1 WITH EVIDENCE AND ONE ACTION

Baseline → observe → identify → test → review.

01

SCORE

Complete 24-item baseline

02

TRACK

Observe a real week

03

SPOT

Identify one pattern

04

CHANGE

Test one adjustment

05

REVIEW

Assess what changed

EXIT TICKET- “One time pattern I noticed is ___; one change I will test this week is ___.”



THANK YOU

Any Question?